

Proposal 1: Non-Profit Organisation

The Green Canopy Initiative" is an organization.

1. Organisation Overview:

Name: The Green Canopy Initiative (TGCI)

The history of TGCI: TGCI started from a small neighbourhood tree planting initiative in 2015 by a group of Environmental science students and community members in response to the accelerated urban deforestation in the Johannesburg metropolitan area. In the last ten years the project was expanded to become a registered non-profit organisation (NPO) with more than 500 volunteers. They have planted more than 10,000 indigenous trees and set up three community vegetable gardens and an educational programme in ten local schools on the theme of environmental stewardship and sustainability.

Vision: To help communities develop and sustain green and sustainable cities through education, action and advocacy.

Mission: To create a future where all South African communities have healthy and resilient green spaces accessible to all and achieve biodiversity and counteract climate change effects.

Target Audience: Local community people (potential volunteers and donors), corporate partners (sponsors), schools and education institutions (collaborative projects), and local government bodies (collaborative projects).

2. Website Goals and Objectives:

Increase Volunteer Registration: Increase the number of registered volunteers by 40% in the first year.

Boost Donations: Provide an easy, secure online donation platform to support an increase of 25% in online donations.

Improve the Community's Engagement: Provide a single source of information about community events, workshops and project information with a goal of 50% attendance at events.

Enhance Communication: Share the organisation's impact in multimedia, such as stories, photos, and videos; and keep the project progress in the public eye.

KPIs: Total of all donations received each month online, number of new volunteer sign-ups per quarter, amount of traffic and time spent on the website (using Google Analytics), number of shares of news and event post, and number of event sign-up conversion rates on social media.

3. Current Website Analysis (If applicable):

Weaknesses: The current website is straightforward, and has a low cost platform, however it is not clear what the core purpose of the organisation is. It features a working contact form and a static list of projects from the past.

Limitations: The website is not mobile-friendly, so not easy to use on mobile phones; the design of the website is dated. Navigation is awkward and giving is tedious (link to an external page). No central calendar for events and little news/blog activity. There is no clear and compelling call to action (CTA) on the home page.

4. Since the website is new, a list of desired features and functionality is included:

Homepage: Lots of attention is drawn to the hero image and the value proposition, with a strong call to action for "Donate Now" as well as "Become a Volunteer."

Our Impact Page: Interactive page with statistics (trees planted, volunteers, etc.) and a photo/video gallery of past and current projects.

"Get Involved" Page: The details of volunteering, corporate partnership and individual sponsorship opportunities with an integrated easy-to-use registration form.

"Events" Page: a completely integrated calendar of events, workshops and public plantings that permits people to RSVP instantly.

"News & Stories" Page: A blog to post stories, press releases and updates from volunteers and project sites to showcase impact.

'Donate' Page: A safe and easy way to give, including one-time and monthly giving, and a 'Gift Aid' (donor tax certificate) facility.

"Contact Us" Page: A straightforward contact form, physical address, contact information and map of the organisation.

5. Create and User Experience:

Colour Scheme: Growth and nature will be represented with a rich deep forest green , and a bright energetic leaf green colour for CTAs and interactive elements. The white will be

used for body text and will be clean and warm, and the charcoal will be used for body text, and will be a neutral color.

Typography:

Headings: Montserrat (sans-serif) – a clean, modern and bold font for a confident, contemporary look.

Body Text: Lato (sans-serif) – a highly legible font on all devices, making reading very friendly and professional.

The design will be mobile-first, prioritizing the user experience on mobile devices over desktop. The design will be mobile-first, meaning it will prioritize the user experience for mobile devices over desktop devices. The layout will be clean, content heavy with images, with large, high-quality photos of people and nature, to evoke an emotional response. Information hierarchy will be apparent and users will be led from the home page to the most significant actions – donating or volunteering.

UX Considerations: Menu is sticky, navigation is simple and user-friendly. Clear and consistent call to actions. Quick load times of all pages, particularly the image gallery. The website will be easily scannable with short paragraphs, bullet points, and clear headings. A small focus group will be used for user testing to make sure it flows smoothly and is interesting.

6. Technical Requirements:

Domains to be hosted (Domain name e.g., thegreencanopy.org.za) It will be hosted on a dependable and scalable server such as Bluehost or SiteGround to guarantee uptime and performance.

Front-end: HTML5, CSS3, JavaScript will be used for the website design, which will be dynamic and interactive. The site will be built to be a content management system (CMS), like WordPress, that will enable staff to be able to edit pages, events, and blog posts without any coding knowledge.

Security: An SSL certificate will be added to ensure that the data is sent securely, particularly through the donation portal. Backups will be made on a regular basis.

7. Project Milestones

Milestone	Deliverable	Target Week
Project Initiation	Project sign-off, approved sitemap	Week 1
Wireframing and Design	Wireframes, mockups, design sign-off	Week 2-3
Front-End Development	Fully coded website pages	Week 4-5
Back-End Setup	Functional back-end system with plugins	Week 6
Content Migration	All pages populated with content	Week 7
Testing and QA	Bug resolution log, testing sign off	Week 8
Final Revisions	Finalised website	Week 9
Launch and Handover	Live website, training completion	Week 10

8. Budget

Item	Description	Cost
Domain Name	.org.za domain registration	R150
Web Hosting	Basic shared hosting plan	R1200
Plugins	Donation plugin + Events calender plugin	R1500
Development	HTML, CSS, JavaScript coding and UI/UX design	R5000
Content Creation	Copywriting, basic images, and graphics	R1000
Maintenance	Security patches, backup, and bug fixes	R2000
Marketing	Social media management and email marketing	R4000
Miscellaneous	Stock photos, font licences	R150
TOTAL YEAR 1 BUDGET		R15000

9. References

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5. [WordPress.org](https://wordpress.org/themes). (2025) *WordPress nonprofit themes*. Available at: <https://wordpress.org/themes> (Accessed: 6 August 2026).